



MANISH GUPTA
CEO, FRAGRANCES
& FASHION
ACCESSORIES,
TITAN

“For some of the top fragrances brands globally, it takes at least six years to launch a variant. Right now, beach and salt are trending”



RAGHAVAN N S
CEO, EYECARE
DIVISION, TITAN

“When I am building a business, it’s not with today in mind but the next 5-10 years. The task is to balance vision and fashion. My multi-price, multi-brand model needs to gel with this”

gold rate. “That’s how much they have evolved. The design sensibility and exposure to social media is homogeneous,” he adds.

In watches, too, despite a dominant share, Titan has a strong desire for growth. The ₹26,000 crore watch industry is split between two price segments—less than and above ₹25,000. “The latter has grown substantially in the last five years,” says Kuruvilla Markose, CEO (Watches Division). About a decade ago, that split was 80% in favour of watches priced less than ₹25,000. It makes sense to invest in a segment where consumer spends are higher.

“Our strategy will be to defend and dominate that market,” says Markose. With a growth rate of about 10% each year, the base is large. The ₹25,000-1 lakh price band is a ₹5,000 crore market, while that between ₹1 lakh and ₹5 lakh is another ₹4,000 crore. “This is the segment where we want to play and one that, we believe, will grow over 30% each year,” he adds.

Jewellery is expected to dominate Titan’s revenue pie for a long time. That said, the numbers present some food for thought. Each year, that business brings in around three million new customers, while for watches, the number is around 17 million, making it the largest contributor. “From here, they become consumers of Tanishq or our eyecare products or fra-

grances,” says Markose.

The lessons from the past are invaluable but Chawla thinks differently. “If you want to win in a new category, you have to immerse deeply into it,” he says. One must build on the learnings and insights but also keep reframing the opportunity.

In the world of marketers, there is a constant need to differentiate oneself. “While that is the right thing to do, the question is, how relevant are you,” says Chawla. To get that right, a company must be innovative. He says there are three components to it—innovation in materials and design (watches is one example), followed by technology (Karatmeter in Tanishq or high-quality optometry machines in eyecare or automation in general) and, finally, at the retail level (through Rivaah wedding jewellery).

At Titan, the credo of simplicity is conspicuous. “In trying to remain relevant, we may not come across as different. So, the balance between the two must be managed well, and that’s not easy,” says Chawla. Titan has successfully done that over time, and now, it is about more competition, changing consumption patterns, technological disruptions and quickly adapting to all this. **BT**

@krishnagopalan